

V03 CIRCULATION NETWORK | O (MAX : 3 PT)

Intent : Encourage stair use through aesthetic design, signage and visibility of staircases.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to design staircases for everyday use and leverage aesthetics, visibility/positioning, and prompts to encourage stair use.

Issue : Physical inactivity and sedentariness have emerged as a primary focus of public health in recent years, due to the host of negative health implications associated with both behaviors.¹⁻⁶ Strategies that promote stair use and general movement throughout buildings have emerged as promising interventions that encourage short bouts of health-enhancing physical activity throughout the day.^{7,8}

Solutions : Evidence from systematic reviews (including international data from a variety of settings, such as airports, healthcare facilities, universities and offices) suggests that stairwell enhancements and signage increase stair use.⁹⁻¹² In particular, point-of-decision design prompts that include directional signage and motivational messaging have been shown to be effective at increasing stair use.⁹⁻¹⁴ Evidence suggests that improving aesthetic and atmosphere with design, music and artwork, as well as tailoring motivational signage and prompts to the audience or population the space serves, may help increase intervention effectiveness.^{9,15,16} Novel strategies, such as gamification, which leverages game elements to encourage desired behaviors, have been introduced as fun and innovative ways to encourage healthy behaviors, such as stairclimbing in both public and private settings.¹⁷ At an infrastructural level, considering where stairs are placed, which is particularly relevant for new construction projects, can have a large impact on movement opportunities throughout the day. Evidence-based guidelines, such as the Active Design Guidelines suggest that stairs should be proximate to main entry points and located physically and visibly before elevator or escalator banks.⁷

PART 1 DESIGN AESTHETIC STAIRCASES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least one staircase is open to regular occupants, services all occupiable floors of the project and is aesthetically designed through the inclusion of at least two independent strategies from the following list on each floor:

- a. Music.⁷
- b. Artwork.⁷
- c. Designed to have light levels of at least 9fc when in use.¹⁹
- d. Windows or skylights that provide access to daylight and/or nature views.^{7,18}
- e. Natural design elements (e.g., plants, water features, images of nature).⁷
- f. Gamification.¹⁷

Note : Interiors projects may earn this feature either through stairs within the project boundary or through base building stairs outside of the project boundary. Stairs must service all floors of the project but do not need to be accessible from the ground floor of the building.

PART 2 INTEGRATE POINT-OF-DECISION SIGNAGE (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least one staircase is open to regular occupants, services all occupiable floors of the project and is supported by the following:

- a. Motivational, point-of-decision signage is present at the following locations:
 1. Near the main building entrance or the reception desk.⁷
 2. At elevator or escalator banks on each floor.⁷
 3. At the base of stairs and stairwell re-entry points on each floor.⁷
- b. If stairs are not visible from signage locations, wayfinding signage is used to guide occupants to the stairs.⁷

Note : Interiors projects may earn this feature either through stairs within the project boundary or through base building stairs outside of the project boundary. Stairs must service all floors of the project but do not need to be accessible from the ground floor of the building. If the project does not access the stairs from the ground floor, they are exempt from requirement a1, which requires signage on the ground floor.

PART 3 PROMOTE VISIBLE STAIRS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least one staircase is open to regular occupants, services all occupiable floors of the project and meets the following requirement:

- a. Is at least as prominent (visual or physical) as elevators/escalators relative to the main point of entry to the building or project space (e.g., entrance to the project on their floor).^{7,18}

Note : Interiors projects may earn this feature either through stairs within the project boundary or through base building stairs outside of the project boundary. Stairs must service all floors of the project but do not need to be accessible from the ground floor of the building.

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